

THE BRAIN BRAKE

Version six. The book of characters, props and locations.

Everything drawn and locked so far, in one place. This is the bible for this film. A drawing that departs from these sheets is off model, and that is the only verdict used here.

Every recurring object gets its own model sheet with several angles, exactly like a character. Without one it is the first thing the tool drops from a busy frame, because it has no identity to hold on to. One sheet costs one credit and saves five.

THE LAW THAT SITS ABOVE EVERY SHEET

Everything drawn is the inside of the problem. Everything photographed is the person who came to look at it. The film is the moment those two stop being separate.

Nobody says this and nothing in the film explains it. It is carried entirely by whether the photograph and the drawing are lit by the same light.

9 the cast

3 props

4 locations

THE CAST

MANAN

CHARACTER REFERENCE SHEET: 14-YEAR-OLD BOY'S BEDROOM, BANGALORE



MANAN.jpg

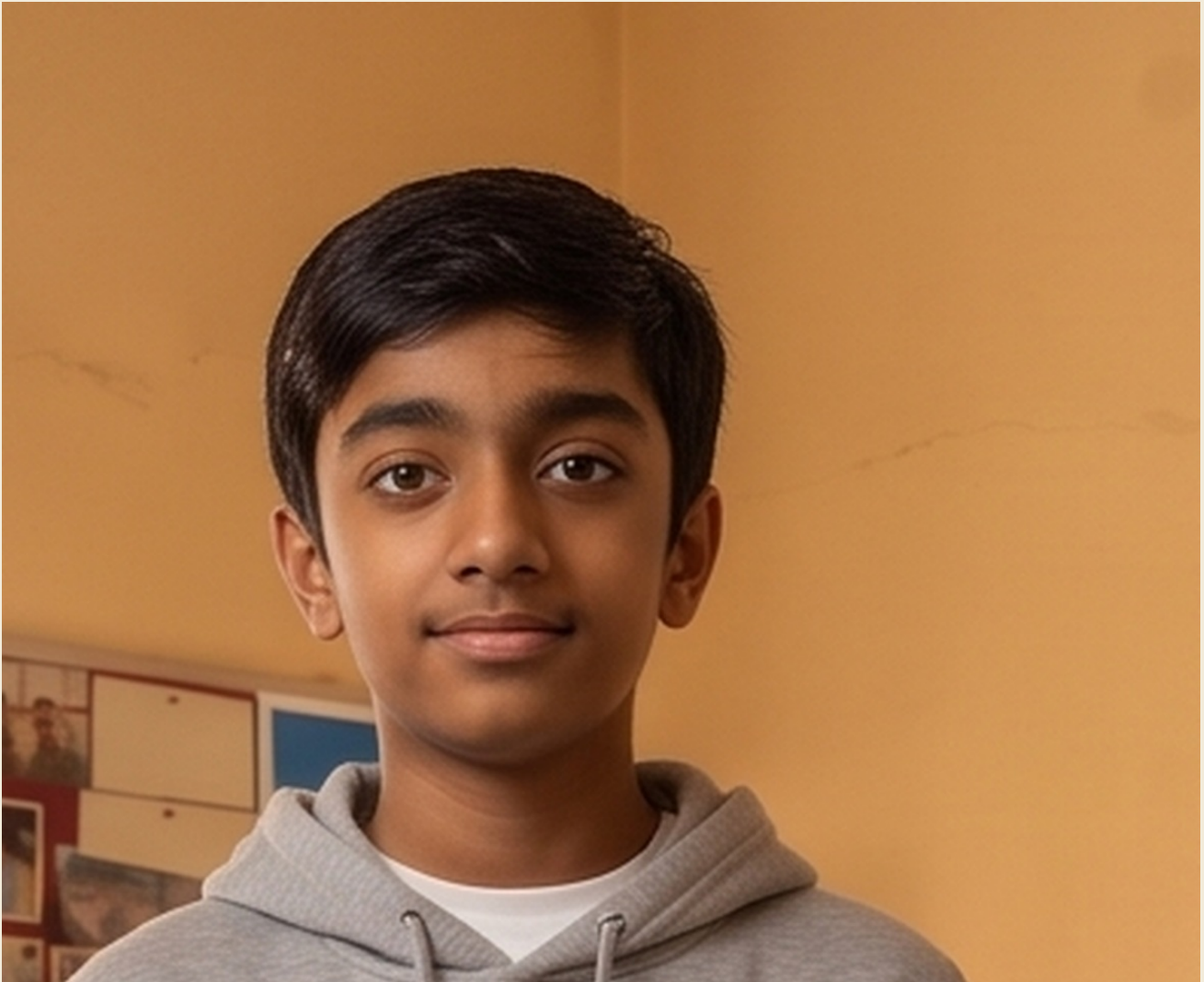
Photographed, never drawn. He is the only real thing in the film and the whole visual idea rests on that: everything drawn is the inside of the problem, everything photographed is the person who came to look at it.

In version six the deerstalker and the coat are gone. He is in his own grey hoodie.

THE SHADOW. Wherever he stands on the drawing the paper goes dark under him, and the pencil lines stay readable through the shadow. The shadow is proof that a photograph and a drawing occupy one space.

Without it he is pasted on, with it he is standing in it. This is not decoration, it is the mechanism of the whole idea.

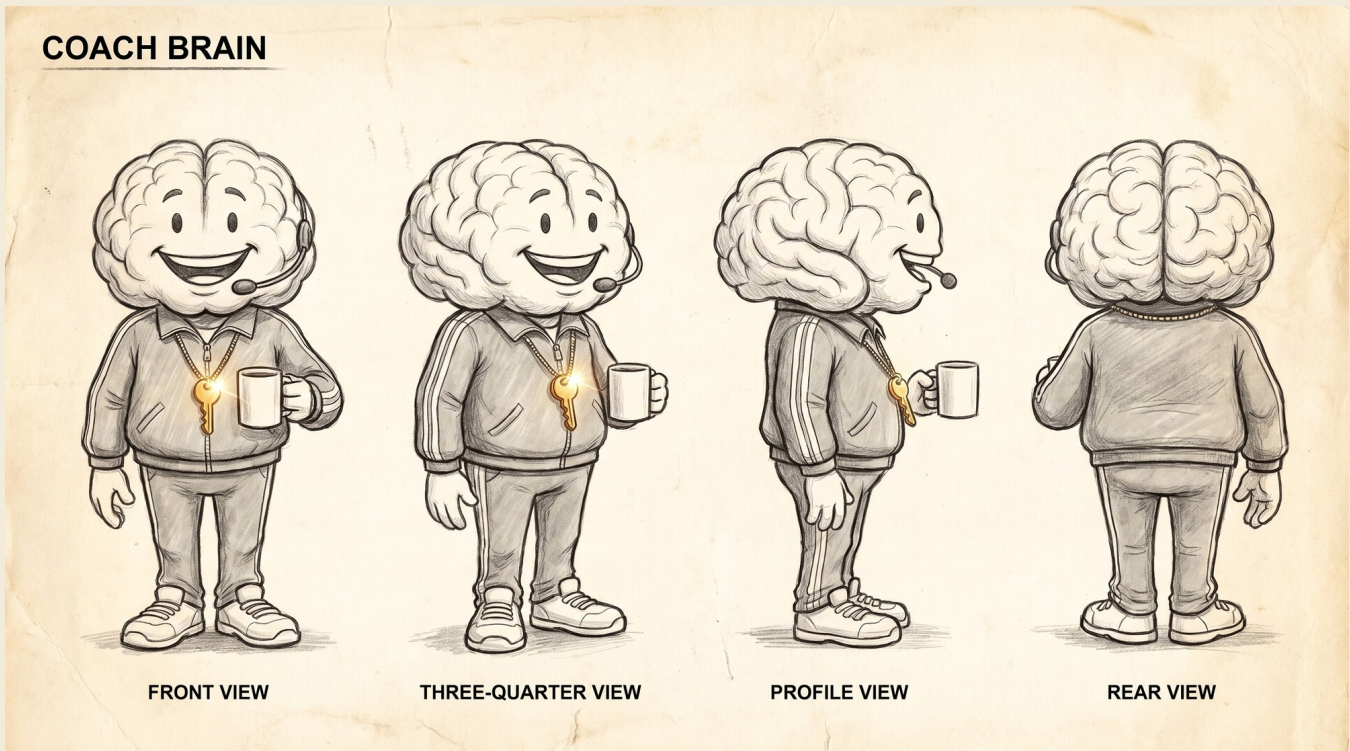
MANAN, CLOSE



MANAN_CLOSE.jpg

For matching skin, hair and eyeline in close ups. He is fourteen years old. Do not age him.

COACH BRAIN

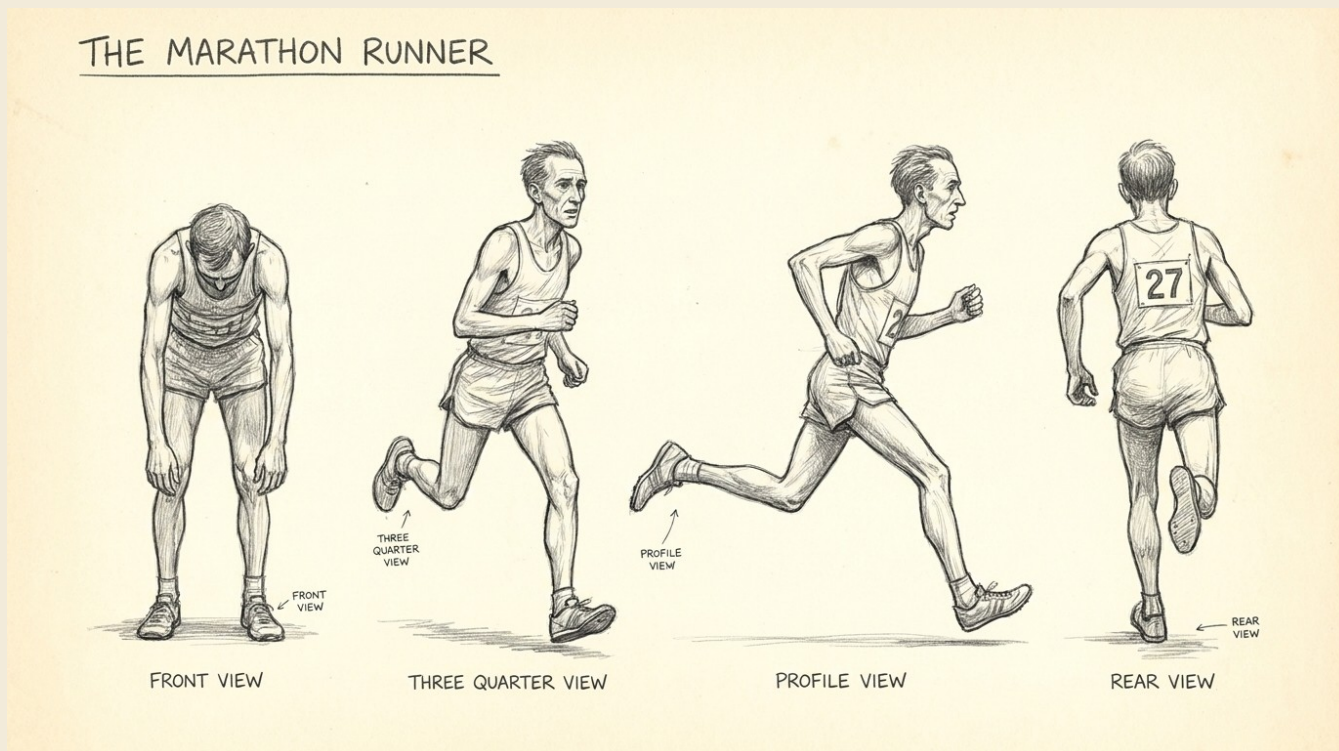


BRAIN.jpg

Four views. Tracksuit, mug, headset, and a small gold key on a chain at his chest. Two and a half heads tall. He is a teacher and not a villain, and there is no villain anywhere in this film. He is never sly and he never looks caught out. He is delighted to have finally been found.

The key is the only colour in the entire film. There is no gold anywhere else.

THE MARATHON RUNNER



RUNNER.jpg

Four views. Lean, about thirty five, number 27 on the vest. He is not old: he is at the end of a race, not at the end of a life, and the first scene fails if he reads as an old man. He appears in the first frame of the film and again in the last. The number 27 is the top of a count that runs through the whole film and is never once remarked on.

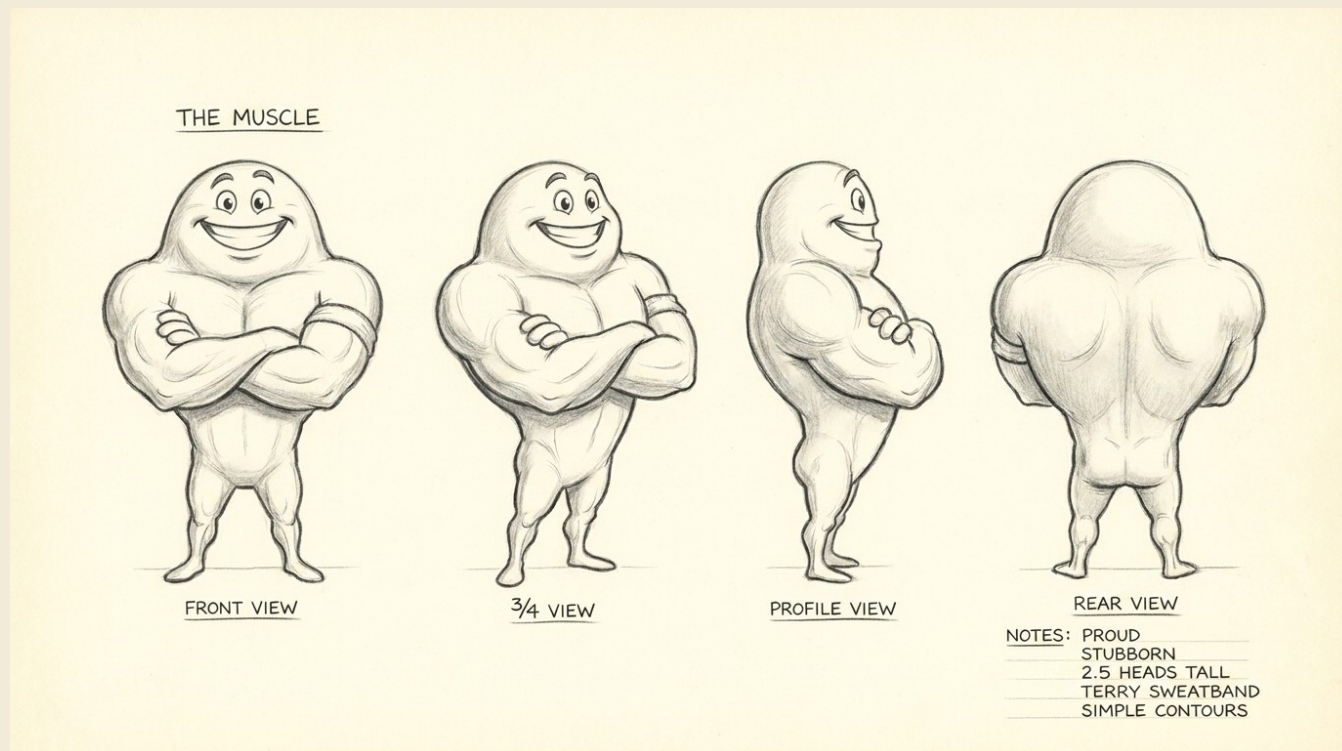
THE RUN CYCLE



RUN_CYCLE.jpg

Four positions of the stride. The same man failing and the same man flying, so the cycle has to hold in both states. Frame 6.4 rhymes frame 1.1 exactly: same composition, opposite feeling.

THE MUSCLE



MUSCLE.jpg

Four views. Proud, stubborn, two and a half heads, terry sweatband, simple contours.

At the end of the film he shakes Coach Brain's hand. Hill was right about the muscle and the film says so out loud. Nobody loses.

THE CAST

THE FACTORY WORKERS

CHARACTER: THE FACTORY WORKERS.

SCALE: 2 HEADS

WARDROBE: OVERALLS, BOOTS, GLOVES, HARD HAT

ACCESSORIES: CLIPBOARD, WRENCH, OXYGEN CRATE



HAULING CRATE.



PULLING LEVER.



PULLING LEVER.



PANICKING.



PULLING LEVER.



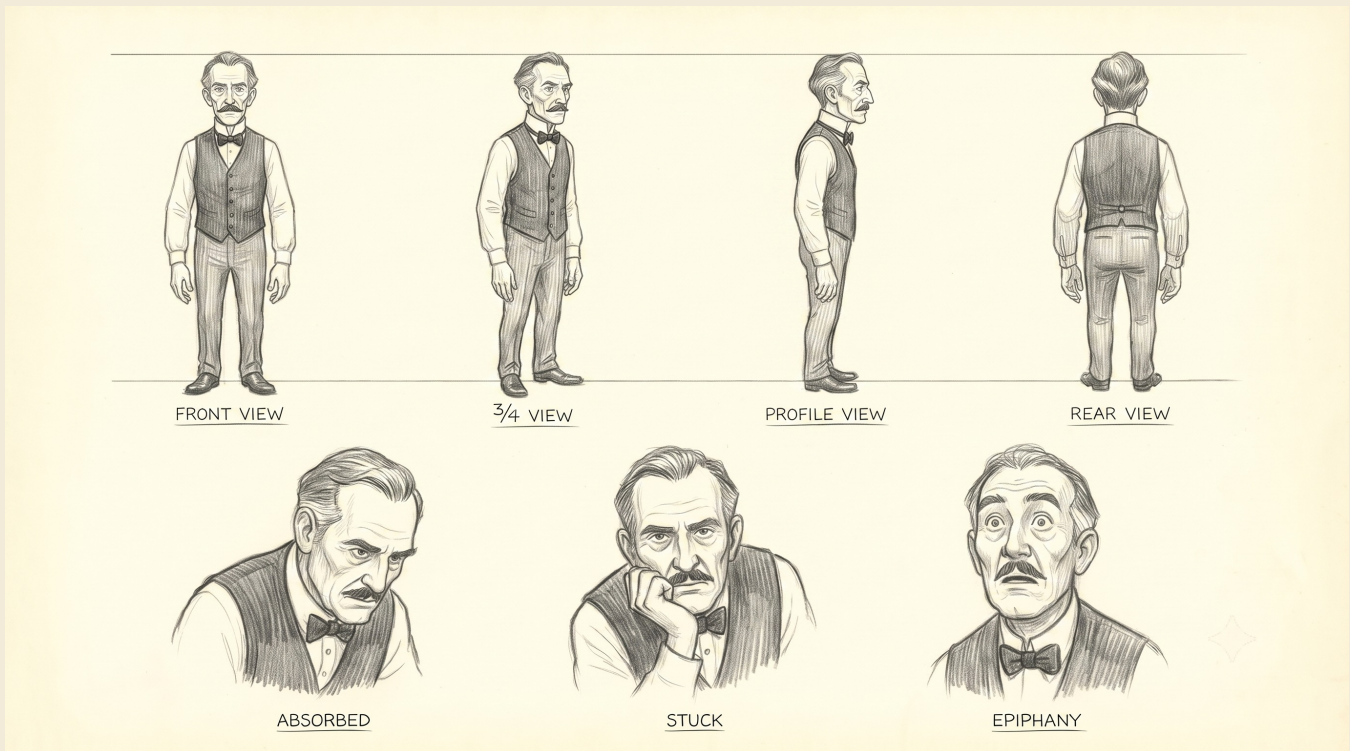
WIPING SWEAT.

WORKERS.jpg

The crew of the old theory. Overalls, boots, gloves, hard hat. Props: clipboard, wrench, oxygen crate. The poses are already drawn: hauling the crate, pulling the lever, panicking, wiping sweat. They are resigned, not frightened. This is a shift ending, not a disaster.

THE CAST

A. V. HILL



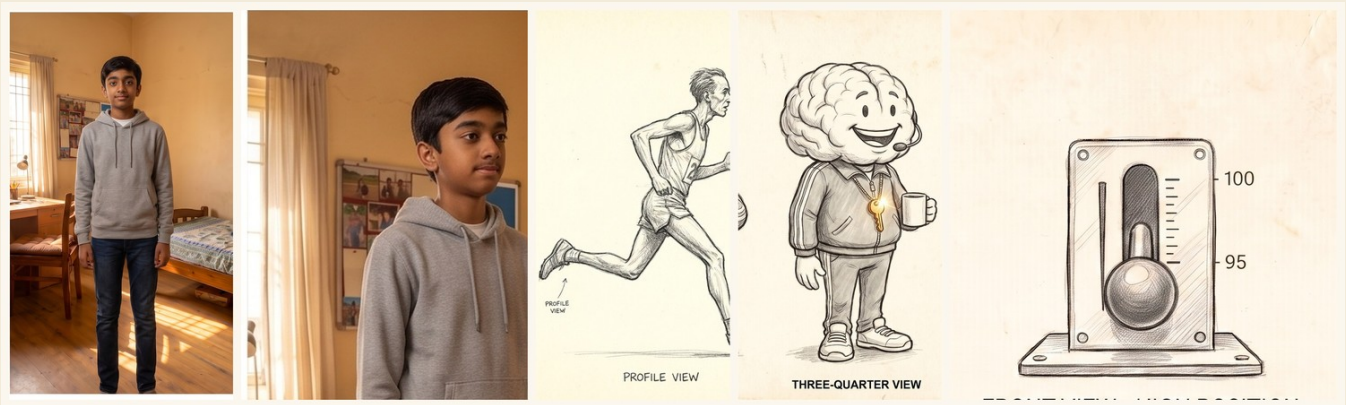
SCIENTIST.jpg

Turnaround and three expressions: absorbed, stuck, epiphany. In version six he hangs as a portrait on the classroom wall in scene two.

He is treated with respect. His theory is incomplete rather than wrong, and he is never mocked.

THE CAST

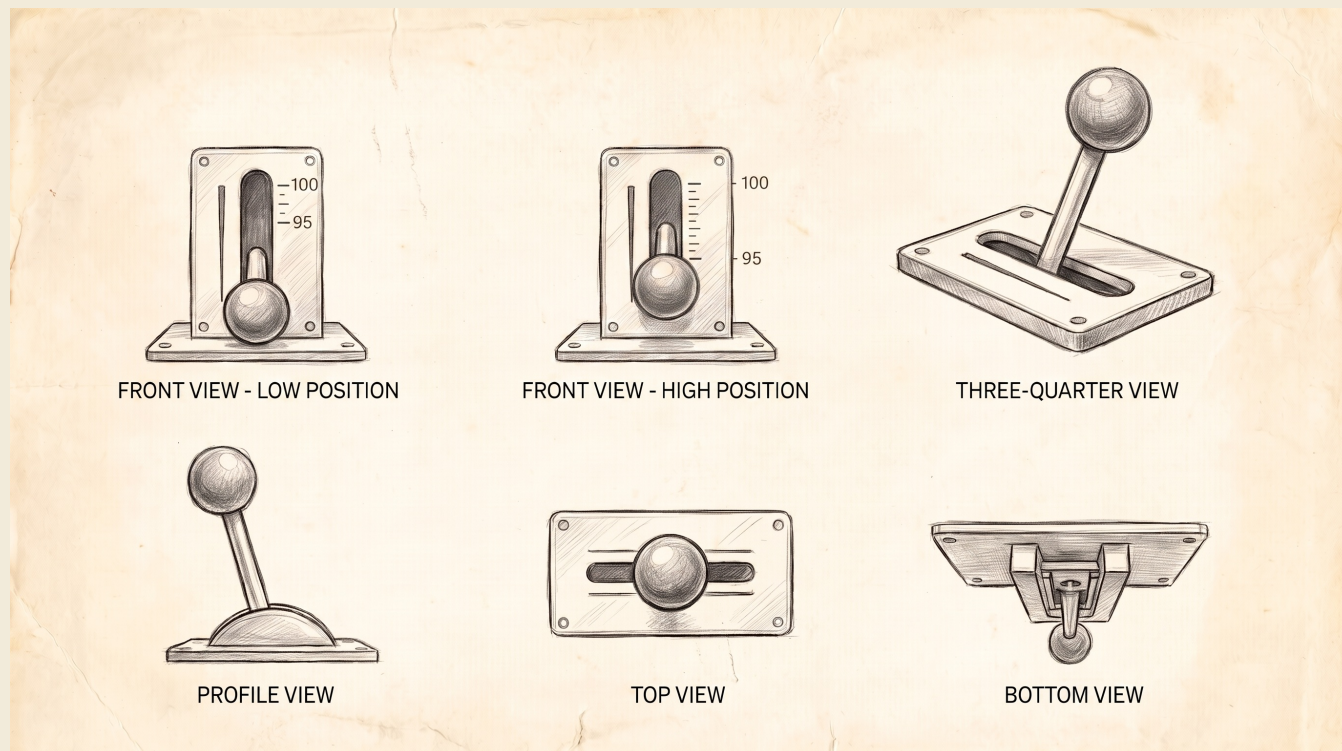
THE CAST TOGETHER, RELATIVE SCALE



CAST_ALL.jpg

Get this wrong and nothing else on these pages helps. Coach Brain and the Muscle are each about two and a half heads. Manan is a real fourteen year old boy and he is the yardstick.

THE LEVER



LEVER.jpg

Six views. The ball is the grip and it sits ON TOP of the shaft. Scale marked 100 and 95. It stops at 95 and never at 100. The gap of open track above the ball is the moral architecture of the whole film and the sentence nobody speaks. Protect it in every frame the lever appears in. In scene 6 the ball starts LOW and travels upward. If it starts high, the whole scene reverses.

THE MAGNIFYING GLASS

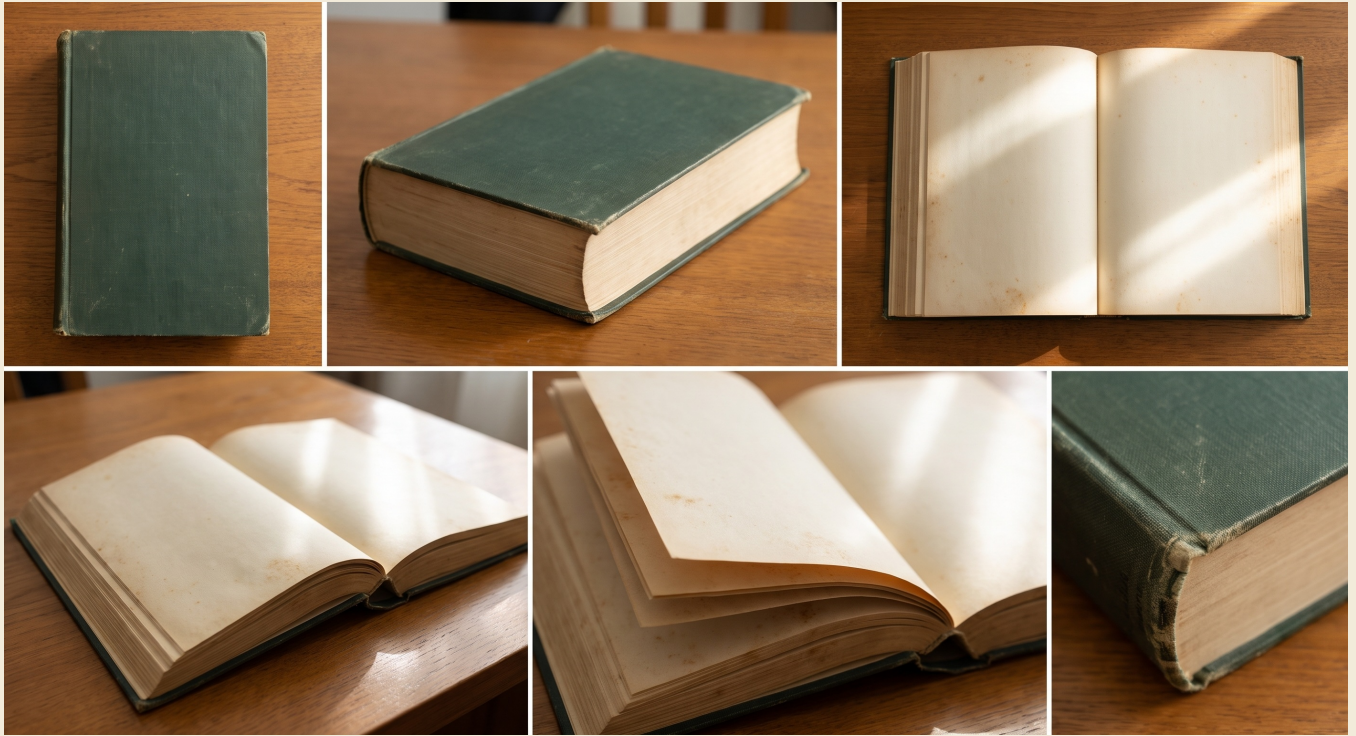


GLASS.jpg

Brass and dark wood, six angles. This is a real object lying on a drawing: it throws a shadow onto the paper, and what you see through it is pencil.

A real instrument showing a drawn interior is the argument of the whole film in one object.

THE BOOK

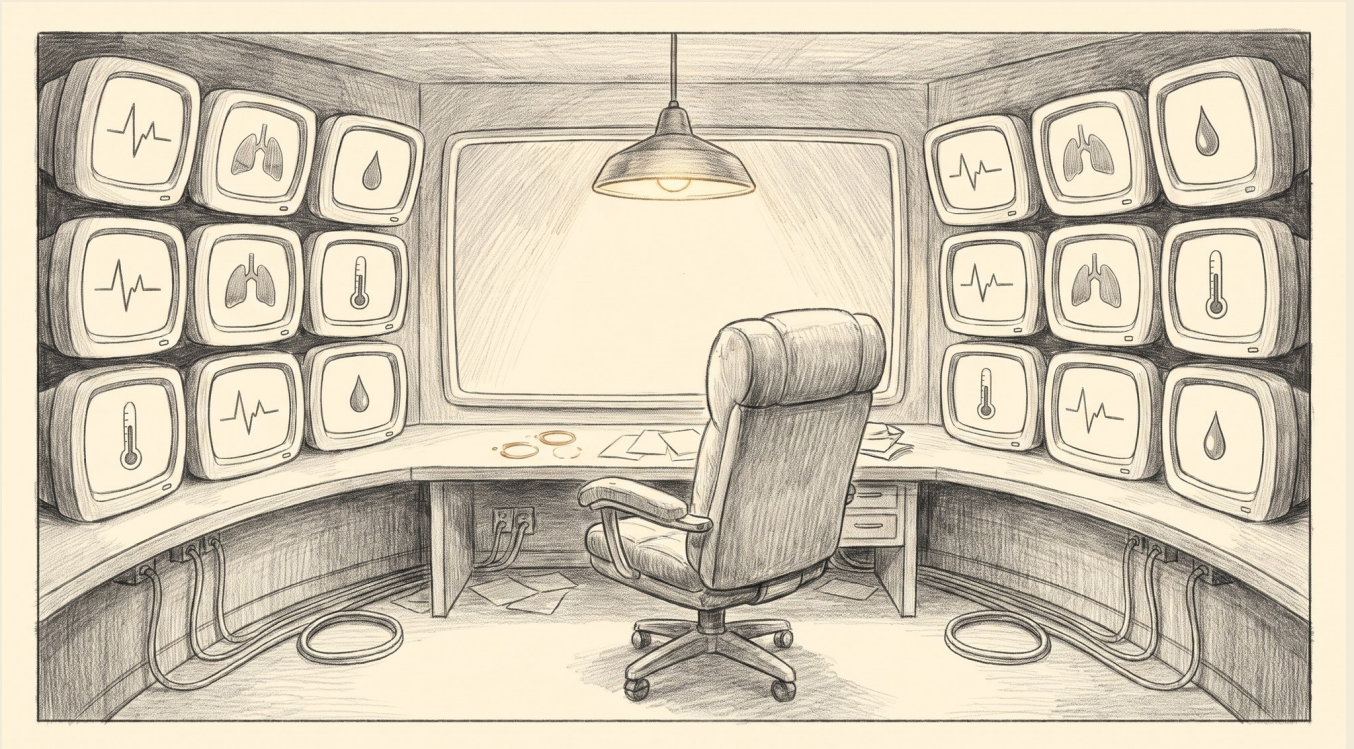


BOOK.jpg

Green cloth. Closed, open, and from the side.

LOCATIONS

THE CONTROL ROOM



BRAIN_ROOM.jpg

Coach Brain's room. Warm, not clinical. Monitors on every wall, one chair.
This is meeting somebody, not catching them. The light has to be welcoming.

THE HALL OF TANKS



TANKS.jpg

Behind the door nobody opened. Nine tanks visible, every gauge full.

This is the reveal and the first big lift in the film. Discovery, not warning. The light arrives as good news.

LOCATIONS

THE 1923 STUDY



LAB.jpg

Three views: full room, desk detail, anatomy corner. Oil lamp, papers, anatomical plates.

There must be no lettering at all on the anatomical plates. The tool invents text and returns it as nonsense.

THE BOY'S BEDROOM, VERSION FIVE

LOCATION REFERENCE SHEET: 14-YEAR-OLD BOY'S BEDROOM, BANGALORE



ROOM.jpg

Built for version five, when the film played out in his room. Version six does not use it: Manan is shot against grey and placed into the drawn world afterwards. It stays here so nobody redraws it by accident, and because it may come back.

SHEETS THAT DO NOT EXIST YET

Ordered by how much damage their absence does.

THE KEY

Small gold key on a chain. Worn by Coach Brain, handed to Manan in the last scene. It appears in five frames, it is the only coloured object in the film, and it has no sheet.

THE DIAL

The round gauge with a needle. Not the same object as the lever. Eight frames across five scenes, drawn differently every time, which is exactly what happens without a sheet.

THE DOOR

The riveted door at the back of the factory, closed and open, with light behind it.

THE FACTORY

The inside of the muscle as a working plant. Gears, belts, crates, gantry. It carries the whole of scene two and part of scene three.

Sheets are 3:2. Frames are 16:9. A sheet is always overwritten at its own filename, forever, so that every prompt already written stays valid.